app developer to ask the user for one-off access to specific files in their Dropbox. Rather than starting an OAuth flow, the app developer instead calls a SDK function that will display a Dropbox-provided file selection UI as shown in figure 9.1. Because this UI is implemented as a separate browser window running on dropbox.com and not as part of the third-party app, it can show all the user's files. When the user selects a file, Dropbox returns a capability to the application that allows it to access just the file that the user selected for a short period of time (4 hours currently for the Chooser API).

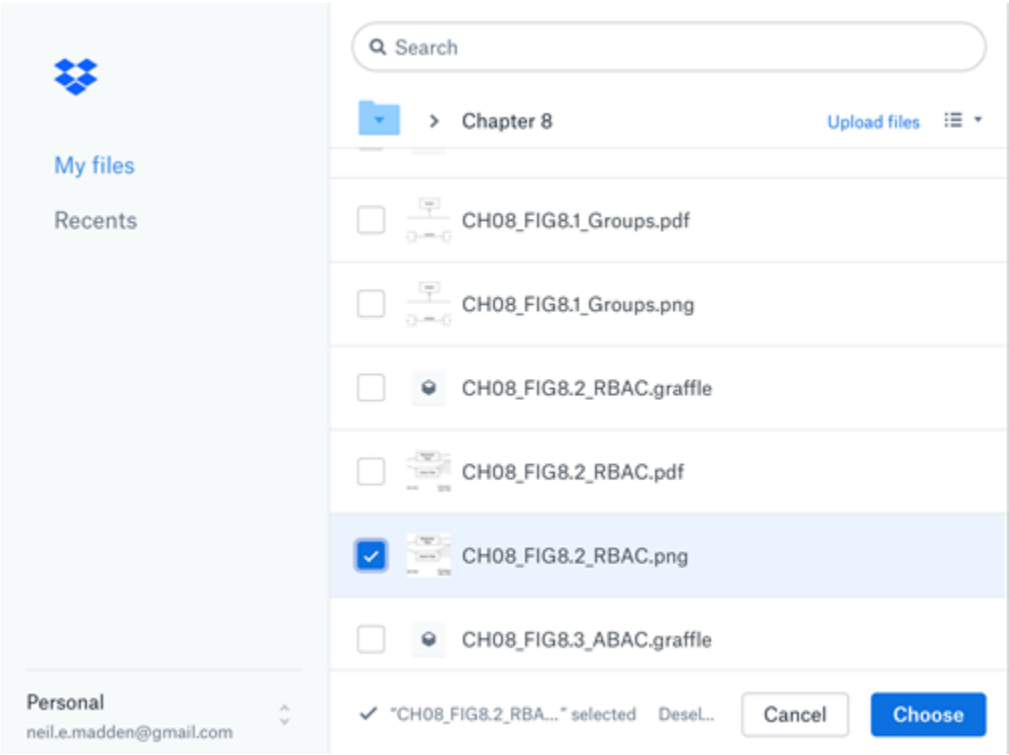


Figure 9.1 The Dropbox Chooser UI allows a user to select individual files to share with an application. The app is given time-limited read-only access to just the files the user selected.